

PORTFOLIO SAMPLE

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READY WHEN

it matters



A practical personal-readiness workbook

Know what matters, organize the essentials, and make it easier for others to help when plans change.

How to use this workbook

Work through the pages in any order. Complete only what is useful, revisit it when circumstances change, and share the pages that someone else may need in an emergency.

Table of Contents

PART ONE: Start with What Matters	3
1. Name What Matters	3
2. Priorities During an Emergency	4
PART TWO: Make It Practical	5
3. Support Needs & Daily Function	5
4. Messages & Key Contacts	6
5. Emergency Decisions	7
PART THREE: Make It Usable	8
6. Document Locator	8
7. If Someone Has to Step In	9
8. Wallet Card & Refrigerator Notice	10
9. Situations That Need Extra Planning	11

Name What Matters

Preparedness is easier when you begin with priorities rather than paperwork. Use this page to name the people, routines, responsibilities, and practical details you would want protected first if an unexpected event disrupted your normal day.

What would feel hardest to leave unresolved?

What do I already know I would want someone else to handle?

Which responsibilities should never depend on one person knowing everything?

Questions I want to answer before I move on:

Priorities During an Emergency

Emergencies rarely unfold in a neat sequence. A plan that works for a short disruption may not work if you are away from home, unable to communicate, or depending on someone else to make arrangements.

You do not need to predict every scenario. The goal is to make your priorities visible enough that another person could make sensible decisions without guessing.

What matters most?

Choose the items that would matter most if someone had to act on your behalf.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Personal safety | ☐ Keeping routines stable |
| ☐ Staying at home | ☐ Contacting family |
| ☐ Medication access | ☐ Financial continuity |
| ☐ Caring for dependents | ☐ Pet care |
| ☐ Protecting important records | ☐ Other: _____ |

Which approach sounds closest to you?

- ☐ **Keep things familiar:** Preserve routines and the current environment whenever it is reasonably safe to do so.
- ☐ **Solve the immediate problem:** Focus on the most urgent issue first, then reassess when the situation is stable.
- ☐ **Accept temporary disruption:** Use short-term alternatives if they reduce risk or make support easier.
- ☐ **Delegate quickly:** Let the designated person make practical decisions within the priorities recorded here.
- ☐ **I'm not sure yet.**

Support Needs & Daily Function

Imagine needing more help than usual for several days: getting around safely, managing meals, caring for a pet, keeping appointments, using equipment, or accessing medications. Which kinds of support could you adapt to, and which would be most difficult?

Which comes closest to your thinking?

- ☐ Temporary help would not significantly change my routine.
- ☐ I could accept substantial help if I could still participate in the parts of daily life that matter to me.
- ☐ I prefer to relocate temporarily if it made support simpler and safer.
- ☐ I would want someone I trust to coordinate decisions and keep others informed.
- ☐ I'm not sure.

The kinds of assistance I think I could adapt to are:

The changes that would be hardest for me to accept are:

Messages & Key Contacts

You do not need to write every message here. Use this page to identify who may need information, what they should know, and the best way to reach them.

PERSON / ROLE	WHAT THEY NEED TO KNOW	HOW TO REACH THEM

Anything I want to say that does not fit neatly into one contact:

Emergency Decisions

Use this page for preferences, not legal instructions.

Local rules and professional advice may still be required. The purpose here is to make your practical preferences easier to find when time is limited.

TEMPORARY PLACE TO STAY

If I cannot remain at home safely:

- ☐ Stay with family/friends
- ☐ Use a hotel
- ☐ Use a temporary care setting
- ☐ Unsure

TRANSPORTATION

If I cannot drive myself:

- ☐ Family/friend
- ☐ Taxi/rideshare
- ☐ Accessible transport
- ☐ Unsure

PET / DEPENDENT CARE

If someone else needs to step in:

- ☐ Use my designated contact
- ☐ Use a backup contact
- ☐ Use a professional service
- ☐ Unsure

Anything else someone making arrangements for me should know:

Document Locator

In an emergency, this table alone can save the people helping you hours.

DOCUMENT	DO I HAVE IT?	WHERE IS THE ORIGINAL?	WHO HAS A COPY?
Photo ID/passport	☐		
Insurance information	☐		
Medication list	☐		
Emergency contacts	☐		
Power of attorney	☐		
Home/lease documents	☐		
Banking information	☐		
Vehicle documents	☐		
Pet records	☐		
Password manager	☐		
Employment/benefits records	☐		
Other critical records	☐		

If Someone Has to Step In

This page is not a full personal history. It includes practical information someone may need to help coordinate your day-to-day responsibilities.

Primary Pharmacy / Essential Service

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Address: _____

Items or equipment I rely on

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Glasses/contacts | ☐ Hearing aids |
| ☐ Mobility aid | ☐ Phone / charger |
| ☐ CPAP / medical equipment | ☐ Accessibility device |
| ☐ Medication organizer | ☐ Other: _____ |

Bring / Arrange first

- ☐ Identification and insurance information
- ☐ Phone and charger
- ☐ Medication list and essential medications
- ☐ Keys/access codes
- ☐ Important documents
- ☐ Comfortable clothes / personal items

Where essential supplies are kept:

Wallet Card & Refrigerator Notice

IN CASE OF EMERGENCY	IN CASE OF EMERGENCY
Name: _____	☐ I have an emergency plan
Emergency contact: _____	☐ I have essential medications
Phone: _____	☐ I have a designated backup contact
Backup contact: _____	Where key documents can be found:
Phone: _____	_____

Cut along the dashed lines, fold in half, and keep it in your wallet or purse.

Refrigerator Notice

EMERGENCY INFORMATION
Name: _____
Primary contact: _____
Phone: _____
Backup contact: _____
Essential documents are located: _____
☐ Emergency plan ☐ Medication list ☐ Pet/dependent plan

Situations That Need Extra Planning

If you live alone: Make sure at least two people know where your essential information is stored and how to reach you. Choose one nearby person who can act quickly if your primary contact is unavailable.

If you care for children, pets, or another dependent: Record the routines, medications, access instructions, and backup contacts another person would need to take over safely for a short period.

If you use essential equipment: Keep model information, supplier details, backup-power requirements, and basic operating instructions with your emergency information.

If you travel frequently: Store a digital copy of critical contact and insurance information somewhere secure and accessible away from home.

Local Resources

Identify a few contacts before you need them. Use official local sources for current information and professional advice.

Local emergency management office: _____

Primary care / health service: _____

Insurance contact: _____

Community support program: _____

Trusted neighbour / nearby contact: _____

Keep it current

Review this workbook after a move, major health change, or new caregiving responsibility, and at least once a year. A short update now is easier than reconstructing critical information during an emergency.